



“WE UNDERSTAND THE ECOSYSTEM”

HCLTech Chairperson Roshni Nadar Malhotra discusses in detail HCL's newest partnership with Foxconn on semiconductor design and manufacturing

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PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

THE RECENT announcement of a partnership between the Taiwanese semiconductor major Foxconn and the HCL Group for setting up an assembly and testing facility has been met with a lot of enthusiasm. Talking to *Business Today* during the World Economic Forum event at Davos in Switzerland recently, HCL Technologies Chairperson Roshni Nadar Malhotra speaks about that partnership, the world of

semiconductor designing, chip manufacturing, and what makes HCL the most suitable company to enhance India's semiconductor dreams. Edited excerpts:



HCL Group has announced a major partnership with Foxconn for chip packaging and testing. What is this about?

Let me rewind a little bit. The genesis of HCL,

starting from 1976, was in manufacturing and [it] was in creating India's first indigenous 8-bit processor-based PC. We shipped the same day as Apple, but we were a closed economy and no one ever covered us. And so there's been a rich legacy. HCL Group, as it exists today, obviously has HCL Technologies as our flagship company at the forefront in the IT services sector. A subset of that is we do a lot of work

in semiconductor design. So it's not that we're coming at it blindly. We have a certain DNA, we understand the ecosystem. So, for HCL Group now, I have to clarify, it seemed like a very strategic thing to do, which is to go into the OSAT [outsourced semiconductor assembly and testing] space.



Does it also seem like going back to the vision of Shiv Nadar, the founding